

FROM MSA TO CA: A BEGINNER'S GUIDE TO TRANSITIONING TO COLLOQUIAL ARABIC (GOMAA)



Lina Gomaa
Portland State University

From MSA to CA: A Beginner's Guide to Transitioning to Colloquial Arabic (Gomaa)

This text is disseminated via the Open Education Resource (OER) LibreTexts Project (<https://LibreTexts.org>) and like the thousands of other texts available within this powerful platform, it is freely available for reading, printing, and "consuming."

The LibreTexts mission is to bring together students, faculty, and scholars in a collaborative effort to provide an accessible, and comprehensive platform that empowers our community to develop, curate, adapt, and adopt openly licensed resources and technologies; through these efforts we can reduce the financial burden born from traditional educational resource costs, ensuring education is more accessible for students and communities worldwide.

Most, but not all, pages in the library have licenses that may allow individuals to make changes, save, and print this book. Carefully consult the applicable license(s) before pursuing such effects. Instructors can adopt existing LibreTexts texts or Remix them to quickly build course-specific resources to meet the needs of their students. Unlike traditional textbooks, LibreTexts' web based origins allow powerful integration of advanced features and new technologies to support learning.



LibreTexts is the adaptable, user-friendly non-profit open education resource platform that educators trust for creating, customizing, and sharing accessible, interactive textbooks, adaptive homework, and ancillary materials. We collaborate with individuals and organizations to champion open education initiatives, support institutional publishing programs, drive curriculum development projects, and more.

The LibreTexts libraries are Powered by [NICE CXone Expert](#) and was supported by the Department of Education Open Textbook Pilot Project, the California Education Learning Lab, the UC Davis Office of the Provost, the UC Davis Library, the California State University Affordable Learning Solutions Program, and Merlot. This material is based upon work supported by the National Science Foundation under Grant No. 1246120, 1525057, and 1413739.

Any opinions, findings, and conclusions or recommendations expressed in this material are those of the author(s) and do not necessarily reflect the views of the National Science Foundation nor the US Department of Education.

Have questions or comments? For information about adoptions or adaptations contact info@LibreTexts.org or visit our main website at <https://LibreTexts.org>.

This text was compiled on 09/24/2025

TABLE OF CONTENTS

About the Book

Licensing

About the Author

Acknowledgments

Abbreviations and Acronyms

Introduction

1: Chapter 1

- 1.1: Transitioning to CA- Final vowelizing and greeting terms in MSA and CA
- 1.2: Greetings and Ending Conversations
- 1.3: Cultural insight- Ending a conversation in a culturally acceptable manner

2: Chapter 2

- 2.1: Transitioning to CA- WH Question words in MSA and CA
- 2.2: Requests
- 2.3: Cultural insights- Giving directions

3: Chapter 3

- 3.1: Transitioning to CA- Verb tenses
- 3.2: Dialogues
- 3.3: Cultural insights- Phone conversations and communicating among different age groups in the Arab world

4: Chapter 4

- 4.1: Transitioning to CA- Negation in MSA vs CA
- 4.2: Accepting and rejecting invitations
- 4.3: Cultural insights- Tips on dealing with culturally sensitive situations

Index

Glossary

Glossary

Detailed Licensing

About the Book

This book is for students who have studied Modern Standard Arabic (MSA) for one year or more and would like to learn colloquial Arabic basics using their knowledge of MSA. It aims at transitioning learners from Novice Mid level to Intermediate Low through presenting situations useful for living in an Arab country. The book has several features including hyperlinks, practice dialogues with open answers, cultural tips, and more.

Licensing

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).

About the Author

Lina Gomaa received an MA in Arabic/English Translation and Interpreting from University of Salford, UK. At Beloit College, USA, she obtained her BA in Creative Writing, with a minor in Journalism. Also at Beloit College, she obtained a certificate in Teaching English as a Second Language. In Egypt, Miss Gomaa obtained a BA in Arabic/English Translation and English Literature from the Faculty of Languages, Alsun, Ain Shams University. At the American University in Cairo, she received the Certificate of Teaching Arabic for non-native speakers. Miss Gomaa has taught Arabic and English to non-native-speakers at several universities in Egypt and the USA. She is a fully certified oral proficiency interviewer by ACTFL. Miss Gomaa's research interests are second language acquisition and translation including holy texts, focusing on the Holy Quran translations into English.

Acknowledgments

This book would not have been possible without the support of the Arabic Section and World Languages and Literatures department at PSU. The Arabic Section fully encouraged me throughout the process of writing this book. Professor Yasmeeen Hanoosh and Professor Jennifer Perlmutter provided full support especially when the book was just a new idea to be introduced to the Open Textbook project.

My dear colleague Cliff Breedlove's insight, suggestions, discussions, editing and support made this book possible. He has been my fresh second pair of eyes; I am grateful to you. I thank Professor Dirgham Sbait for encouraging me to teach Colloquial Arabic and sharing his extensive experience with me.

The library team has been an asset to make this project a reality. Mrs. Karen Bjork's knowledge in copyright, time management, and unlimited resources are priceless. She has been wonderful to work with, easing any hurdles in the way. Mrs. Stephanie Doig's help and insight took the financial burden off my shoulders and allowed me to focus on writing. Thank you.

My dear students, John Flachetta and Mariah Denman, the delightful future of PSU Arabic studies, have been committed to learning Arabic and recording with me the dialogues for this book. Their clear and strong speaking skills are models for PSU Arabic students to follow.

I will not forget to thank all my students, whose questions, comments, and suggestions have shaped my teaching and perception of my own language, just like water is always shaping the rocks.

Thank you, Mum and Dad for your prayers, love, and belief in the importance of education and language learning.

Last but not least, I thank God: You are my light.

Abbreviations and Acronyms

Abbreviations and Acronyms	Meaning
CA	Colloquial Arabic
ECA	Egyptian Colloquial Arabic
LCA	Levantine Colloquial Arabic
MSA	Modern Standard Arabic
n.	noun
v.	verb
f.s.	feminine singular
m.s.	masculine singular
f.s.2	feminine singular with second person (أَنْتِ)
m.s.2	masculine singular with second person (أَنْتَ)
LM	Literal Meaning (word for word meaning)
IM	Intended Meaning

Before reading this book, please keep in mind the following:

When there are no vowels like damma, kasra, fatḥa (تَشْكِيل, حَرَكَات) on the last letter of the word, it is considered a sukun°.

Introduction



Figure 1: "Islamic Architecture - Dome Building" by KingofColesaw

The teaching methodology for Colloquial Arabic continues to engender controversy in the field of Arabic pedagogy. One approach is firstly teaching Modern Standard Arabic (MSA), then teaching colloquial Arabic (CA); another is introducing both MSA and CA at the same time. A third approach is starting with CA then introducing MSA, which is less common in USA and Middle East educational institutions.

At Portland State University (PSU), the Arabic program is designed to teach MSA for at least one year, after which the students can learn CA. Because of how the Arabic program at PSU is designed (similar to many programs in the USA), the importance of this book arises. This transition can be challenging for some students.

Many current texts do not address the transition from MSA to CA. Some authors assume that both varieties are taught at the same time, or that colloquial is taught first. These approaches are not the best fit for the PSU program design. This book provides information needed to transition from MSA to CA and is useful for PSU students and any student who is following the same pattern in learning Arabic.

The book targets students in NM (Novice Mid) who have studied Arabic for a year or more and aims to help them advance to IL (Intermediate Low) according to the [Oral Proficiency Interview standards by ACTFL](#), the American Council on The Teaching of Foreign Languages. This book documents answers to questions from students in CA classes. It is also a reference for students to “get a feel” for MSA and CA similarities and differences.

Content is displayed at the beginning of each chapter. Section A discusses a feature in MSA and compares it with CA. Section B has dialogues with different topics related to section A; each dialogue is preceded by a table that has three columns: the word in Arabic, the word in English, and the equivalent word/expression in MSA. In the second column “the meaning in English,” I included both the literal meaning (LM) and the intended meaning (IM). Including the LM, as I noticed in class, makes the words/expressions more memorable to the students and more comprehensible even though it might not sound idiomatic or make full sense in English.

The last section of the chapter (C) is cultural insight related to the main topic, making the students more culturally familiar with acceptable behaviors and offering ideas to consider while living in an Arab country. At the end is a glossary organized in English for easier search.

This book is not meant to be a comprehensive treatment of all the issues arising when learning CA after learning MSA. Its goal is to transition students smoothly from MSA to CA, giving them confidence to explore both varieties while reaching the NH (Novice High) or IL level, navigate predictable social situations in CA, and utilize their previous knowledge in MSA to learn CA.

The content and structure are based on my teaching experience and as an ACTFL OPI interviewer to assist students in their quest to speak CA with native speakers with relative ease.

In this book, you will notice several features, one of which is adding a practice dialogue at the end of each chapter to encourage speaking. From my interactions with beginning students, I noticed that they like to practice speaking with Arabic native speakers but are shy or not confident enough or do not know how to reach them. The practice dialogue section is a venue for gaining confidence, where the speaker in the recording pauses during the dialogue, leaving lines for the student to complete orally and in writing. This allows the student to have a real conversation during the recorded dialogue.

In addition, you will find vowelings on some of the words when first introduced to help in correctly reading them. From the second time onwards, the vowelings disappear. Thus, students receive help the first time when they read the full vowelings of the word, then encouragement to remember the correct pronunciation by more practice, while having a reference.

Vowelings is somewhat rare in CA books because this is how Arabic native speakers read. However, I noticed that students have struggled with reading and practicing many words even after listening to them in the audio recording. This is partially because many MSA books are heavily vowelized. For some students studying MSA, switching to CA where the books have no vowels is unsettling. Thus, I have attempted to reach a middle ground between both approaches in this book where vowelings are used only when a new word is introduced then disappear after its introduction.

Transliteration is not employed because the target students of this book have had one year of Arabic or more and can read Arabic script.

One final feature is having hyperlinks to resources, including more information about cultural items and songs. For songs in particular, I am not expecting the students to fully understand what is being said, but the exposure to the language can gradually lead to fluency, increase interest in the Arabic culture, and provide chances to listen to different speakers' intonation and terminology.

Since I grew up in Cairo, this book introduces the Cairene Egyptian dialect; however, it also explains commonly used expressions in the Levant (Jordan, Syria, Lebanon, Palestine, and Israel). The goal is to introduce students to more varieties, allowing them to choose which dialect to specialize in and still be able to communicate with Arabic speakers. Although this book does not introduce Gulf dialects, many of the expressions and terms are frequently used in most of the Arab world, and many are derived from MSA.

I sincerely hope that this book will benefit students of Arabic at PSU and elsewhere, reduce their textbook expenses, and help them improve their CA speaking. I also hope that the dialogues (recorded by PSU students of Arabic) will be enjoyable for learners and provide successful examples for others to follow.

This book will be used in classes and the wider online audience. I welcome suggestions and comments to improve the content and format in future editions.

Learning Outcomes:

On completion of this book, the students should be able to:

- Differentiate between MSA and CA (particularly Egyptian)
- Navigate predictable social situations in CA including:
 1. Greetings in formal and informal settings
 2. Asking questions and making requests
 3. Expressing themselves in the present, future, and past in CA
 4. Using negation in the present
 5. Accepting and rejecting invitations

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

1: Chapter 1

- 1.1: Transitioning to CA- Final vowelizing and greeting terms in MSA and CA
- 1.2: Greetings and Ending Conversations
- 1.3: Cultural insight- Ending a conversation in a culturally acceptable manner

This page titled [1: Chapter 1](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa](#) ([PDXOpen publishing initiative](#)).

1.1: Transitioning to CA- Final vowelizing and greeting terms in MSA and CA

- One of the first points to keep in mind is that in CA, final vowelizing is almost absent except for words like: أهلاً، عفواً، شكراً

For example, you say in MSA, “Are you a student?”

هل أنت طالب؟

But in CA, you will drop the final vowelizing as well as هل (we will explain in chapter 2 what changes take place regarding “WH-” words). So, the same question will be:

إنت طالب؟

- You might have noticed that the hamza همزة in تـأن has changed from fathā to kasra but no changes have taken place on the ت. These changes will come easily to you with more listening, interacting, and practicing in CA

Greeting terms in MSA and CA: الـسالمات والتحيات.

- During your studies of MSA, you have probably learned greetings such as:

صباحالخير- مساء الخير- كيف حالك؟



Figure 1.1.1: "HANDSHAKE GREETING" BY OCTAVIOLOPEZ

Greetings do not significantly change from MSA to CA, but there are more expressions used in CA (with even some repetition in meaning). It is common to ask “how are you” several times using different expressions, as you will read in the coming dialogues. It is part of the Arabic culture to greet your friends or acquaintances by asking multiple times about them and their families to show warmth and care. Let’s see some examples:

الشرح Explanation	المعنى بالإنجليزية English Translation	الرد بالعامة Response in CA	المعنى بالإنجليزية English Translation	التحية بالعامة Greeting in CA
In MSA, there is a final damma on the م ; which is dropped in CA. This greeting is used in several settings. For example, when one is passing by a group of people and wants to say hello quickly. It will not be said to ask about how one is doing. In more religious settings, like the mosque, the م and/or final damma will be pronounced. In everyday settings, the م is often deleted and replaced by و . Listen to this funny song [YouTube] that might give you a feel of how native speakers use this greeting.	"On you" is peace, meaning peace be upon you.	عليكم السلام عليكو السالم	Peace be upon you	عليكم السلام
In MSA, the attached possessive pronouns have the case endings: كُ (أن) your book for (كُ كتاب) your book for (كُ كتاب) for (كُ كتاب). In CA, the MSA final vowel shifts to the letter before the attached pronoun; كُ becomes كُ. Similarly, كُ كيف and كُ في.	Thank God We Thank God We thank God perfect; fine Good When the speaker is male (LCA) When the speaker is female.	الحمد لله نحمد الله نشكركم الله نقام منين منينة	How are you? male recipient (LCA) female recipient	كيفك؟ كي فك؟
		Same answers as above	How are you? male recipient (ECA)	رك إيه؟ أخبا عامل إيه؟
		Same answers as above	How are you? male recipient (LCA) female recipient	رك؟ شو أخبا رك؟ شو أخبا
The MSA damma on صبا disappears in CA	Morning of light Morning of Jasmine الفل:	صباح الثور صباح الفل و(الباسمين)	Good Morning	صباح ال خي ر

الشرح Explanation	المعنى بالإنجليزية English Translation	الرد بالعامية Response in CA	المعنى بالإنجليزية English Translation	التحية بالعامية Greeting in CA
	is a kind of Jasmine [Wikipedia]			



Figure 1.1.1: "JASMINE FLOWER PETALS" BY DORNE

This page titled [1.1: Transitioning to CA- Final vowelizing and greeting terms in MSA and CA](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa \(PDXOpen publishing initiative\)](#).

1.2: Greetings and Ending Conversations

1. Formal Greetings Conversations: At Work

0:00 / 0:00

مُحَادَثَةٌ رَسْمِيَّةٌ بِالْعَامِيَّةِ

كَلِمَاتٌ وَتُعْبِيرَاتٌ مَهْمَةٌ:

الكلمة والتعبير بالمساوي بالفصحى The equivalent in MSA	المعنى بالإنجليزية The meaning in English	الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية The word and expression in CA
الْيَوْمَ	today	التَّهَارِدْه
لَكِنْ also in CA	but	بَسْ
عَمَلْ also in CA	work	شُغْلْ
كثيراً Notice that in some dialects (e.g., ECA, LCA), ث sometimes changes into ت. Other dialects (e.g., Gulf) keep it the same as in MSA.	a lot	كِتِيرْ
أَيْضاً also in CA	as well/ too	كمان
تُمْ / بَعْدَ ذَلِكَ	after this/ then	بعدين
The same expression is used in MSA.	God willing	إِنْ شَاءَ اللّٰه

الحوار رقم (1)

This is a conversation between coworkers in a company as an example of a formal setting.

أحمد: صباح الخير يا سارة
 سارة: صباح النور يا أحمد، إزيك؟ عامل إيه التَّهَارِدْه؟
 أحمد: تمام، الحمد لله، وإنْتِ عاملة إيه؟
 سارة: كوبسة، بَسْ عِنْدِي شُغْلْ كِتِيرْ
 أحمد: وأنا كمان والله
 سارة: طيب يا أحمد، نَتَكَلَّمْ بعدين إن شاء الله.
 أحمد: إِنْ شَاءَ اللّٰه!



Figure 1.2.1: "Business Executives Talking near Printer" by mconnors

2. Informal Greetings Conversation: At a Friends' Gathering

▶ 0:00 / 0:00

محادثة غير رسمية بالعامية

كَلِمَات وَتَعْيِيرَات مهمة:

الكلمة والتعير بالمساوي بالفصحى The equivalent in MSA	المعنى بالإنجليزية The meaning in English	الكلمة والتعير بالعامية The word and expression in CA
Same word with different internal vowelings: نَجَحَ	passed/succeeded	نَجَحَ
same	his exams: إِمْتِحَان + ات + ه	إِمْتِحَانَاتُهُ
Almost the same in MSA except for changing one word أَحْسَنَ مِنْ قَبْلُ You can use this above-mentioned expression in CA as well	LM (literal meaning): "better than the first" IM (Intended meaning): the situation is better than before	أَحْسَنَ مِنْ الْأَوَّلِ
Same word with different internal vowelings (on the attached pronoun) سُؤَالُكَ سُؤَالُكَ	your question female recipient your question a male recipient	سُؤَالُكَ (إِنْتِ) سُؤَالُكَ (إِنْتِ)
Same word with different internal vowelings حَبِيبَتِي	my dear one a female recipient Note, if this word is used between two people in love, it will mean "my loved one".	حَبِيبَتِي

الحوار رقم (2)

This is a conversation between two female friends at a gathering as an example of greetings in an informal setting.

نورا: أهلاً يا دُعاء، كيفك؟
دعاء: منيعة، نُشْكُرُ الله وأنتِ؟ كيفك؟
نورا: تمام، الحمد لله. كيف (ال) ماما و(ال) بابا؟
دعاء: بخير، الحمد لله. وشو أخبار ياسر، أخوك، نَجَحَ في إِمْتِحَانَاتِهِ؟
نورا: الحمد لله، وكيف صَحَّةُ جَدِّكَ؟
دعاء: أَحْسَنَ مِنْ الْأَوَّلِ، شكراً على سُؤَالِكَ (يا) حبيبتي!

3. Practice: Complete the Dialogue

This is an incomplete dialogue in the audio files. Practice speaking by completing the missing parts in this dialogue.

▶ 0:00 / 0:00 ———— 🔊 ⋮

هالة: أهلاً! أهلاً! كيفك؟

_____، _____: إنت/ إنت:

هالة: تمام، الحمد لله. كيف ماما؟

_____، _____: إنت/ إنت:

هالة: وكيف بابا؟

_____، _____: إنت/ إنت:

هالة: بخير، شكراً على سؤالك!

This page titled [1.2: Greetings and Ending Conversations](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa](#) (PDXOpen publishing initiative).

1.3: Cultural insight- Ending a conversation in a culturally acceptable manner

It is polite to end a conversation gradually, whether with a coworker, a friend or a relative (especially if elderly or older than you). It is impolite to end a conversation abruptly unless it is an emergency.

A very acceptable and polite way to end a conversation is explaining that you are sorry that you have to leave but will hopefully talk soon or meet soon (especially with older people). It is more relaxed with younger generations. Consider the following template for wrapping up a conversation, whether in person or over the phone:

أنا آسِف / آسِفَة بس لازم أمشي علشان . . . :

I am sorry but I have to leave (go away/ walk away) because:

I have an appointment	عندي ميعاد
I have work	عندي شغل
I have an exam	عندي إمتحان

نتكلّم بَعْدَين / قُرَيْبَ إن شاء الله.

We will talk later/ soon, God willing.

This page titled [1.3: Cultural insight- Ending a conversation in a culturally acceptable manner](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa \(PDXOpen publishing initiative\)](#) .

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

2: Chapter 2

2.1: Transitioning to CA- WH Question words in MSA and CA

2.2: Requests

2.3: Cultural insights- Giving directions



Figure 2.1: "Islamic Architecture" by [King of Coleslaw](#)

This page titled 2: [Chapter 2](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa \(PDXOpen publishing initiative\)](#) .

2.1: Transitioning to CA- WH Question words in MSA and CA

Generally, there are few internal vowel changes in the MSA WH question words when they are used in CA. Let's have a look together:

الشرح Explanation	المعنى بالإنجليزية The meaning in English	أداة الاستفهام بالعامية WH-" word in CA"	أداة الاستفهام بالفصحى WH-" word in MSA"
Same uses as MSA	how	كَيْفْ	كَيْفَ
Same uses as MSA	how much/many	كَام	كَمْ
Same uses as MSA	?...What is the cost of	يَكَام	يَكَمْ
Same uses as MSA	where (LCA) where (ECA)	وَيْنْ فَيْنْ	أَيْنَ
Same uses as MSA	who	مَيْنْ	مَنْ
Same uses as MSA	when	إِمْتَى	مَتَى
Same uses as MSA	what	شُو (LCA) إيه (ECA)	ماذا
Same uses as MSA but slight difference in pronunciation in MSA; it can be أَيْ أو أَيْْ أو أَيْْ depending on the words used with أَيْ and its grammatical position in the sentence.	which	أَيْ	أَيَّ
Not used in CA	for Yes/ No questions	Not used in conversations, replaced by rising intonation for yes or no questions	هل / أ

أمثلة لاستخدام أدوات الاستفهام

Examples of using WH words in short dialogues

▶ 0:00 / 0:00

أحمد: كيف الحال؟
سارة: الحمد لله، تمام.

أحمد: الساعة كام؟
سارة: تقريباً واحدة.

أحمد: الكمبيوتر ده بكام؟
سارة: ١٠٠٠ جنيه.

سارة: فين الحمام لو سمحت؟

أحمد: على اليمين.

سارة: مين الأستاذة ديه؟
أحمد: ديه أستاذة فدوة، أستاذة الأدب الروسي.

سارة: إمتى الحفلة؟
أحمد: الساعة خمسة.

سارة: تحب تشرب إيه؟
أحمد: شاي لو سمحت.

سارة: شو تحب تشرب؟
أحمد: قهوة من فضلك.

(في الصف)
سارة: الواجب في أيّ صفحة في الكتاب؟
أحمد: عشرين.

This page titled [2.1: Transitioning to CA- WH Question words in MSA and CA](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa](#) (PDXOpen publishing initiative) .

2.2: Requests

1. Taxi

الجوار رقم (1)

كلمات وتغييرات مهمة:

الكلمة والتعبير العامية The word and expression in CA	المعنى بالإنجليزية The meaning in English	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى The equivalent in MSA
سَوَّاق	driver	سَائِق Usually in CA, the ء is either deleted or changing in form. In this case, it is deleted and is replaced by a و and a ّ (shadda) In MSA, sometimes سيارة أجرة is used. LM: "a car with a fare."
التاكسي	taxi	تَعم Also used in CA
آه	This word can mean "yes" in response to questions in Egyptian Arabic (as in the coming dialogue). It can also be a sound .made when one is in pain	أنتِ عِنْدُكَ Same word with different internal vowelings.
عِنْدُكَ (إنتِ) عِنْدُكَ (إنتِ)	IM: "you have" LM: "at you" because عند means "at" & ك is an attached pronoun	أنتِ عِنْدُكَ
عَدَّاد	meter	same
شَوَّية	a little bit شَوَّية is the Egyptian for a few or little شَوَّي is levant for a few or little. Example: I want a little water, please. عايز شَوَّية ميه لو سمحت. I want few apples, please. عايز شَوَّية تفاح لو سمحت.	The equivalent in MSA is قليلاً and it can mean a few or little.
حُسْن (إنتِ)	enter (m.s.2 imperative)	No equivalent
شِمَال	left	It is used in MSA, together with يَسَار. Both are used in MSA and CA. In Gulf countries يسار is used more often
طَيِّب	OK/ alright Note: this word has 3 meanings: 1) ok/alright 2) delicious (food) 3) kind a person	same
شِمَال في يَمِين	left then right In this expression, في means "immediately after" left then right immediately, with no streets/roads in between	Not used in MSA in this manner.

الرَّيْثُونَةُ: مصر الجديدة؟

سَوَّاق التاكسي: آه.

الرَّيْثُونَةُ: عِنْدَكَ عَدَّادٌ؟

سَوَّاق التاكسي: أَيْوَة.

الرَّيْثُونَةُ: تَمَام.

بَعْدَ شَوْبَةٍ....

الرَّيْثُونَةُ: مِنْ قَضَلِكَ حُشْ شِمْال!

سَوَّاق التاكسي: طَيِّب.

الرَّيْثُونَةُ: عِنْدَ السوبر ماركت، حُشْ شِمْال فِي يَمِينِ

سَوَّاق التاكسي: طَيِّب.

الرَّيْثُونَةُ: عَايِزَة أَنْزِلْ هُنَا لَوْ سَمَّحْتَ.

سَوَّاق التاكسي: هُنَا فِين؟

الرَّيْثُونَةُ: عِنْدَ السوبرماركت، إِنْفَضِّل.

سَوَّاق التاكسي: شُكْرًا.



Figure 2.2.1: "Taxi Cab" by Alvimann

2. Requesting Train Tickets

▶ 0:00 / 0:00 ———— 🔊 ⋮

كَلِمَاتٌ وَتَعْبِيرَاتٌ مَهْمَةٌ:

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة و التعبير المساوي بالفصحى
لَوْ سَمَّحْتَ (إِنِّ) لَوْ سَمَّحْتَ (أَنْتَ)	If you please - female recipient If you please - male recipient	إذا سمحت Used in MSA and more formally
مِنْ قَضْلِكَ (إِنِّ) مِنْ قَضْلِكَ (أَنْتَ)	If you please female recipient If you please male recipient	Same words with different internal vowelings; مِنْ قَضْلِكَ (أَنْتَ) مِنْ قَضْلِكَ (أَنْتَ) As you might have noticed, أَنْتَ with the ء on the 'Alif is MSA while in CA, the ء is below the 'Alif, causing the difference in pronunciation; same with أَنْتَ in MSA becoming إِنِّ or إِنْتِ.
تَذَكَّرْ	ticket In some countries like Egypt and Sudan, the ذ changes in pronunciation to be z. In other countries, like in the gulf, the ذ is pronounced the same as in MSA.	same
على فين؟	No exact English equivalent except the closest IM: "Where are you heading?" LM: "To where?"	إلى أين؟
رايح	IM is "is/are going" but it is not a verb in Arabic. It could be translated as the "goer" or in this dialogue "are going."	ذاهب It is اسم فاعل or active participle, meaning the doer of the action. It can replace the verb and be translated as "going."
رايح - جِيَّ	IM: "return ticket" LM: "going and coming back"	يُزَاحِبُ وَيُزَابِ
وَلَا	or	The equivalent in MSA is أَوْ which is used in CA. But وَلَا is not used in MSA. (Watch this song in CA [YouTube] where the signer is using وَلَا throughout the song).
قَطْرُ	train Note: the ق in most of Egypt and parts of the Levant is pronounced as ء (a glottal stop). In some dialects, it is pronounced as ج or just like MSA.	قطار
الصُّبْحُ	the morning	الصَّبَاحُ
باليل	at night	باليل Sometimes in MSA and CA فِي is used as well in place of ب to mean "at."

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامة	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى
دَرَجَة	In the context of the coming dialogue, it means "class" in a train.	Same and "step" or, if one is talking about the weather, it means "degree temperature" درجة الحرارة
بِسْتَيْن جنيه	IM: "60 Egyptian pounds (cost)" LM: " with 60 Egyptian pounds"	same
إِنْقَصَلِي	here (offering s.th.) female recipient	Same but with the deletion of the initial in CA
إِنْقَصَل	male recipient	تَقَصِّلِي تَقَصِّلُ
الفِلُوس	money	مال
بالسلامة	IM: "travel safely" LM: "with safety"	



Figure 2.2.2: "Steam Engine Train" by pambenn

الجَوَّار رَقْم (2)
المُساَفِر: لَو سَمَحْتِ، مِمَكَن تَذَكَّرَة؟
المُوطَّفَة: عَلى فِين؟
المساَفِر: إِسْكَنْدَرِيَّة إِن شَاء اللّهِ
المُوطَّفَة: رايح بس وَلَا رايح - جَيّ؟
المساَفِر: رايح بس مِن قَصَلِكُ
المُوطَّفَة: طيب، عَايز قَطِر الصّيح وَلَا بِاليل؟
المساَفِر: مِمَكَن بِاليل.
الموطَّفَة: قَطِر السّاعَة كام؟ سِتّة ولا تسعة؟
المساَفِر: تسعة.
الموطَّفَة: دَرَجَة أَولى ولا تانيّة؟
المساَفِر: بِكام تذكّرة الدّرجة الأَولى والتّانيّة؟
الموطَّفَة: الدّرجة الأَولى بِسْتَيْن جنيه والتّانيّة بِأربعين.
المساَفِر: دَرَجَة أَولى، إِنْقَصَلِي الفِلُوس.
الموطَّفَة: بِالسلامة إِن شَاء اللّهِ.
المساَفِر: شُكْرًا.

Note

A very useful expression that is commonly used is “مُمْكِن” which means “It is possible.” When your intonation is rising, “مُمْكِن” means “Is it possible?” as in the previous dialogue.

3. At the restaurant



Figure 2.2.3: "Bell Peppers" by Scarletina

▶ 0:00 / 0:00 ———— 🔊 ⋮

كلمات وتعبيرات مهمة:

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامة	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى
أهلاً وسهلاً فيكي أهلاً وسهلاً فيك أهلاً وسهلاً بيكي أهلاً وسهلاً بيك	welcome female recipient (LCA) welcome male recipient welcome female recipient (ECA) welcome male recipient	أهلاً وسهلاً بك (أنت) أهلاً وسهلاً بك (أنت)
تحيي.... (إنت)	LM: "you (f.) like" IM: "would you like?" when followed by a rise in intonation	same
المُنْبُو	the menu	فائمة الطعام Still used in restaurants and newspapers together with the borrowed word المُنْبُو
يَدِّي	I want	
(عايز- عايزة)	does not change with speaker's gender	
طَبَق	dish or plate alternatively, unlike English.	same
مُلفوف	stuffed leaves (LCA) It is called مَحْشِي (ECA)	
إشي	something (LCA) حاجة (ECA)	شيء
تاني	In the context of the coming dialogue, it means "another" but it can also mean "second."	ثاني second آخر "another"
رُز	rice	أرز
حَلِيب	milk (LCA) (ECA) لَبَن In Egypt, yogurt is رَبَاي while in the Levant, لَبَن is yogurt.	same
شويّ	شويّ is levant for a few or little. شويّة is the Egyptian for a few or little Example: I want little water, please. عايز شويّة ميه لوسمحت I want few apples, please. عايز شويّة تفاح لو سمحت	قليلاً
عَجَبِكْ	"The LM: "pleases you"	أَعْجَبَكَ
طَيِّب	delicious. See taxi conversation for more information	لَذِيذ same word or
الشيك	"LM: "check (n.)" IM: "receipt or bill"	This word can be used in MSA as a borrowed term

الجوّار رقم (3)

الجار سونة: أهلاً وسهلاً فيكي.

الزبونة: أهلاً.
 الجار سونة: شو تحبّي تشرّبي؟
 الزبونة: أحب أشرب عصير لمون/ ليمون.
 الجار سونة: إتفضلي المنيو، شو تحبّي تأكلي؟
 الزبونة: بدّي ملفوف وطبق حُمص كبير.
 الجار سونة: إشي تاني؟
 الزبونة: لأ.
 الجار سونة: أيّ حلويات؟
 الزبونة: ممكن رز بالحليب.
 بعد شوي.....
 الجار سونة: الأكل عجيبك؟
 الزبونة: كثير طيب، ممكن الشيك؟
 الجار سونة: إتفضلي.
 الزبونة: شكراً.



Figure 2.2.4: "Basket of Vegetables" by macrocasin

4. Practice: Complete the dialogue

0:00 / 0:00

This is an incomplete dialogue in the audio files.
 completing the missing parts in this dialogue:

Practice speaking by

كلمات وتعبيرات المهمة:

الكلمة بالعربية	المعنى بالإنجليزية
ميدان	(city) square
الصيّدليّة	pharmacy

الزبونة: ميدان شوبرا؟

سوّاق التاكسي:

الزبونة: عندك عداد؟

سوّاق التاكسي:

الزبونة: حُش شمال هنا لو سمحت عند البنك

سوّاق التاكسي: _____
الزبونة: هنا لو سمحت.....هنا عند الصيدلية، إتفضّل
سوّاق التاكسي: _____

This page titled [2.2: Requests](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa](#) ([PDXOpen publishing initiative](#)) .

2.3: Cultural insights- Giving directions

Giving directions in colloquial Arabic is giving hands-on directions, asking the person to take different turns and heavily using landmarks. GPS or Sat Nav has not been in much use in several Arab countries. Many people depend on each other for directions. For example, it is very common in Cairo for taxi drivers to ask pedestrians for directions or even drivers ask taxi drivers while waiting in a stop or sometimes while driving!

Landmarks can be supermarkets, pharmacies, restaurants, banks, etc. You can be given an address whose literal translation sounds like this:

17 Ahmed 'Orabi Street by HSBC bank, first floor, apartment 5.

In Arabic:

١٧ شارع أحمد عرابي بجانب بنك مصر، الدور الأول، شقة ٥

Therefore, when you are going to a new place, leave early and keep the phone number of the destination available to call in case you need further directions.

This page titled [2.3: Cultural insights- Giving directions](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa](#) ([PDXOpen publishing initiative](#)) .

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: Chapter 3

3.1: Transitioning to CA- Verb tenses

3.2: Dialogues

3.3: Cultural insights- Phone conversations and communicating among different age groups in the Arab world

This page titled [3: Chapter 3](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa](#) ([PDXOpen publishing initiative](#)).

3.1: Transitioning to CA- Verb tenses

In MSA, there are additions, known as prefixes and suffixes, added to the root when the verb is conjugated in the present tense. These remain largely the same in CA, but in some dialects (ECA, LCA), بَ is added at the beginning of the verb to indicate habitual action. For example:

MSA: أَكُلُ الثُّفَاحَ فِي الصَّبَاحِ

CA: بَأْكُلُ الثُّفَاحَ فِي الصَّبَاحِ

Let's read and listen to more examples of present tense conjugations in MSA and CA:

▶ 0:00 / 0:00

المعنى Meaning	الفعل المضارع في العامية Present Tense (CA)	الفعل المضارع في الفصحى Present Tense (MSA)	الضمائر المنفصلة Independent Pronouns
I understand	بَأْفَهِمُ / بَقْهَمُ	أَفْهَمُ	أنا
read (m.s.2)	بَتَقْرَأُ	تَقْرَأُ	إِنَّتَ (MSA أَنْتَ)
write (f.s.2)	يَتَكْتَبِي	تَكْتُبِينَ	إِنَّتِ (MSA أَنْتِ)
he eats	يَأْكُلُ	يَأْكُلُ	هو
she plays	يَتَلَعَّبُ	تَلْعَبُ	هي
we drink	يَشْرَبُ	تَشْرَبُ	إحنا (MSA نحن)
you (all) cook	يَطْبُخُوا	تَطْبُخُونَ	إنتو (MSA أنتم)



Figure 3.1.1: "Islamic Architecture: Indoor Sitting Space" by KinfofColeslaw

This page titled 3.1: Transitioning to CA- Verb tenses is shared under a CC BY-NC license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by Lina Gomaa (PDXOpen publishing initiative).

3.2: Dialogues

1. At the sports club

كلمات وتعبيرات مهمة:

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى
النادي	the club Unlike English, where the club can be a night destination for dancing and partying, النادي in several Arab countries refers to a sporting club. For nightclub, “disco” or “night club” is used.	same
أنتَ فين من زمان؟	LM: “Where are you from a long time?” IM: “Where have you been?”	أين أنتَ؟ The expression من زمان means from a very long time. Listen to this song .
عاش من شافِك (إنْتِ)	LM: “Whoever sees you will live.” A compliment signifying happiness to see the person, usually said when two people have not seen each other in a long time.	N/A
والله	LM: “by God” IM: emphasis	same
مَشغول	busy	same
شُغِل	work	same
لدرجة إنك تنسى أصحابك	LM: “to the extent that you forget your friends”	same
باصحى	ب+اصحى I wake up	أصْحُو أو أُسْتَيْقِظ
ويعدين	ثم then	ثُمَّ
بأفطر	ب+ افطر I eat breakfast	أفطر
على طول	LM: “along the length” IM: “all the time” The expression can also mean “immediately,” or “straight” when giving directions, or “honest” when describing a person.	N/A
إِجْتِمَاعَات	meetings singular: إِجْتِمَاع	same
مُتَاقَشَات	discussions singular: مُتَاقَشَة	same
خِناقات	fight and arguments	same
دَوْشَة	noise	صَوَّاء
أَرْجِع	I return أرجع لـ... أرجع لبيت أحمد I return to Ahmed’s house	Same, but the preposition used after this verb is إلى.

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى
ياكل العشا	I eat dinner	أَكَلَ العشاء The ء in MSA changes in CA or sometimes deleted.
بانام	I sleep	أَنَام
يَوْمَكَ	your day (f.s.2)	يَوْمُكَ m.s.2 يَوْمُكِ f.s.2
مَلِيَان	filled (objects) chubby (person)	مَلِيء
المُدير	boss/ director	same
مَسْئُول عَنْ	responsible for	same
حَاجَة	something (ECA)	شَيْء
أَوْلَادِي	my children	أَطْفَالِي same and also
بَارَاكِيْز	I study	أَدَاكِيْز
الوَاجِبَات	homework (it is plural in Arabic) LM: "assignments"	same and "duties."
بَارُوح	I go	أَذْهَبُ
رَبَّنَا مَعَاكِي	May God be with you رب + نا = Our God/Lord	اللّٰه مَعَكَ
ومعك	مع ++ ك (ي) = With you LM: "and with you" IM: "May God be with you as well."	ومعك

▶ 0:00 / 0:00 ————— 🔊 ⋮

لِحَوَارِ رَفَم (1)

(في النادي)

هُدَى: مَحْمُود....يا محمود!

محمود: أهلا أهلا! هدى! ياه!

هدى: إنت فين من زمان؟

محمود: عاش من شافك.... أنا و الله مَشْغُول في الشُّغْل

هدى: ليه؟ لدرجة إنك تنسى أصحابك! لا لا

محمود: و الله كل يوم، باصحي بدري حوالى الساعة سبته و بعدين أسوق للشُّغْل و بعدين باقُطر هناك...و على طول إجتِمَاعَات و مُناقشات و خِناقات....دُوشة... و بعدين بَارُجَع البيت وياكل العشا و بانام

هدى: ياه! إنت يَوْمَكَ مَلِيَان شُغْل

محمود: أنا المُدير و مَسْئُول عَنْ كُل حاجة...إنتِ عاملة إيه
هدى: و الله ، أنا كمان مشغولة مع أولادي...كُل يوم بازايّر معاهم للوَاجِبَات و بازُوح مَعاهم المَدْرَسَة و بنام الساعة عَشْرَة بَعْد يوم
طويل...بَس يَبْرُوح النادي كُل يوم جُمعة
محمود: رَبَّنَا معاكِي يا هُدى
هدى: ومعاك يا محمود...يَحِب نَلْعَب تِنِس؟
محمود: يلا!

How to form the future tense:

In MSA, there are two ways to form the future, by adding **سَ** as a prefix or the word **سَوْفَ** , both before the present tense. For example

I play in the (sporting) club. أَلْعَبُ فِي النّادِي.

I will play in the (sporting) club. سَأَلْعَبُ فِي النّادِي.

In CA, the equivalent of **سَ** is the letter **هَ** or **جَ**.

I will play in the (sporting) club. هَالْعَبُ فِي النّادِي.

I will play in the (sporting) club. هَالْعَبُ فِي النّادِي.

2. Missing a lecture at the university

كلمات وتعابير مهمة:

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى
إبه يا نادية؟	What is wrong, Nadia?	It said in several different ways: ماذا يَك يا نادية؟ هل هناك شيء ما؟
إنت عَيَّانة؟	Are you sick?	هل أنت مَرِيضة؟
عندي بَرْد	LM: "At me is cold" IM: "I have cold"	same
خارج	I will go	سأذهب
خارج لِلدُّكْتُور	I will go to the doctor.	سأذهب إلى الدكتور. أو سأذهب إلى الطبيب. Notice that the preposition after أَذهب in MSA is إلى while it is ل in CA.
بُكْرَة	tomorrow	غداً
حاشِترِي	I will buy	سأشتري سوف أشتري
دَوَا	medicine	دواء
فيتامين سي	vitamin C	same
سَلَامَتِكَ	May you feel better. (root م.ل.م)	same
الله يَسَلِّمُكَ	response to the previous LM: "May God make you safe/sound"	same
صَحِيح	"correct" or "by the way," as in the following dialogue.	It means "correct."
فيه واجب قَاتِنِي	There is = فيه LM: "There is homework which I missed/passed by me." فاتني = فات + ن + ي فات: gone ن is added with the attached pronouns in verbs (an MSA rule extended to CA). ي means mine (an MSA possessive pronouns used in CA).	هناك واجب فاتني
حنقرا	we will read	سنقرأ سوف نقرأ
الجزء الأول	the first part/ chapter	same
الرَّوَايَة	the novel	same
لِمُحَاضَرَة	for (the) lecture ل + محاضرة	same
الأدب الإنجليزي	English literature	same
حَيَكْتِب	we will write/compose	سنكتب سوف نكتب

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى
بَحْث	research/paper	same
أَحْد	I take	أَحْد In some dialects, the ذ stays the same as MSA and in others like ECA, ذ changes into د.
أَحْد مِنْكَ	I take from you	أَحْد مِنْكَ
المحاضرات	lectures	same
ديه	this (non-human plural as well as singular feminine)	هذه
يوم الخميس	Thursday	same
أكيد	surely	same
حادّيكى	I will give you (f.s.2)	سأعطيك سوف أعطيك
حشوفك	I will see you	سأراك سوف أراك
في الكافيتريا	at/in the cafeteria	same
تَعْبِتِكَ معايا	LM: "I made you tired with me." IM: "I caused you lots of trouble." (an expression to thank a person for help)	Complimenting and thanking for people's help is crucial in the Arabic culture. This expression and its response can be said in different ways but the message is the same.
ما فيش تعب ولا حاجة	The response LM: "there is neither tiredness nor anything." IM: "there is no trouble at all."	
سلام	LM: "peace." (shortened form of good bye) It is used among young people who are close friends. It is considered rude if it is at the end of a conversation with an elder. The response is the same.	same
نونو	term of endearment In the Arabic culture, they give each other endearing names. If the person's name has a ن like in نادية, the endearing name could be نونو. If the person's name is جمال, the endearing name could be جيمي or جوجو. Also also used with babies and children.	N/A
جميلة	LM: "beautiful." (Used in this context to express endearment. Only used among close friends and loved ones.)	same

Listen to the conversation between two female friends over the phone; Nadia is sick and has missed lectures at the university.



Figure 3.2.1: "Vintage Brass Phone" by pedrojperetz

0:00 / 0:00

الجوار رقم (2)

نادية: ألو...مين معايا؟

هدى: أنا هدى...إيه يا نادية؟ إنت فين؟ إنت مش في الجامعة ولا في النادي... إنت عيّانة؟

نادية: أيوة، عُندي بَرْد. حَاروح لِلدُّكْتُور بُكْرَة و حَاشِيتِي دوا و فيتامين سي.

هدى: سَلَامِيْكَ.

نادية: الله يَسَلِّمْكَ...صَحِيح، فيه واجب قَائِي إِنْهَارْده في الجامعة؟

هدى: آه، حنقرا الْجُزء الأول من الرِّوَاية لِمَحَاضِرَة الأدب الإنجليزي و حِنَكْتَب بَحْث.

نادية: مُمكن آخُذ مِثْكَ المَحَاضِرَات ديه يوم الخميس؟

هدى: أَكِيد إن شاء الله حَادِيْكَ المَحَاضِرَات و حشوفك في الكافيتريا يوم الخميس.

نادية: شكرا يا هدى، تَعَبِيْكَ معايا.

هدى: مافيش تَعَب ولا حاجة...سلام يا نونو.

نادية: سلام يا جَمِيلَة.

How to form the past tense

Forming the past tense in CA is the same as MSA except that the final vowelizing is suppressed to be sukun and sometimes there are internal vowelizing changes:

MSA: كَتَبْتُ

CA: كَتَبْت

MSA: لَعِبْتُ

CA: لَعَبْتُ

In the first example, the only changes were at the end of the word in CA. The final letter is unvoiced and pronounced with a sukun. In the second example, two changes took place in the CA. The first is the unvoiced last letter. The second change is the middle letter root of the verb ع. It has a كسرة in MSA, and it changed into فتحة in CA.

The verbs شرب and فهم are examples of verb form 1 on the pattern of فَعَلَ in MSA; this pattern vowels changes to a--a or i--i in CA^[1].

This means that in MSA verbs like شَرِبَ and فَهَمَ with kasra in the middle will be in CA a--a (fatha--fathaa) or i--i (kasra--kasra) on the first and the second letter of the pattern one verb. In some dialects and even within different towns in Egypt, they can be pronounced شَرَبَ and فَهَمَ.

Read and listen to the past tense conjugations sampling form 1 verbs:

0:00 / 0:00

الضمائر	الفعل	الماضي في الفصحى	الفعل الماضي في العامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية	التعليق
أنا	فَهِمْتُ	فَهِمْتُ	فَهِمْتُ	I understood	ف takes kasra, and the final vowel is sukoon
إنت	دَخَلْتُ	دَخَلْتُ	دَخَلْتُ	entered (m.s.2)	final sukoon
إنت	كَتَبْتُ	كَتَبْتُ	كَتَبْتُ	wrote (f.s.2)	no change
هو	أَكَلَ	أَكَلَ	أَكَلَ	he ate	final sukoon
هي	لَعِبْتُ	لَعِبْتُ	لَعِبْتُ	she played	ل takes kasra, and the final vowel is sukoon
إحنا	شَرَبْنَا	شَرَبْنَا	شَرَبْنَا	we drank	ش takes kasra
إنتوا	طَبَخْتُمْ	طَبَخْتُمْ	طَبَخْتُمْ	you (all) cooked	و final



Figure 3.2.2: "Petra Ancient Carved Sandstone Temple" by mandit1990

In the following dialogue, you will find verbs like **تَكَلَّمْتُ** and **تَقَرَّرْتُ**. These are form 5 in MSA , **تَقَرَّرْ تَكَلَّمْ** , In CA, **ل** is added at the beginning of the verb (form 6 also^[21]). In addition, the vowel on the second root letter is kasra.

Examples: Form 5

MSA	CA
تَكَلَّمْتُ أَحْمَدَ عَنِ الدَّرْسِ.	أَحْمَدُ إِنكَلَّمَ عَنِ الدَّرْسِ.
تَعَلَّمْتُ الطَّالِبَةُ الْعَرَبِيَّةَ.	الطَّالِبَةُ إِنْعَلِّمْتُ عَرَبِيَّ.

As you can see, the **ل** is added in the verb form 5 in CA and kasra in the middle root letter. The root letters of **تَعَلَّمَ** are **ع. ل. م** and for **تَكَلَّمَ** are **ك. ل. م**.

On a different note, you might have noticed that in CA, the sentences are mostly nominal if the doer is mentioned.

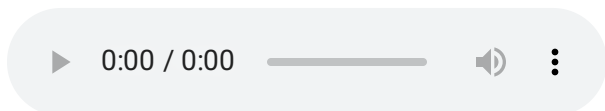
After the following dialogue, some features of the weak verbs used in the dialogue are explained:

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامة	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى
مالِك؟	What's wrong (with you)? (m.s.2)	مَا لَكَ؟
شَكَّلَكَ مِخْتَاخ نوم!	LM: "You look as if you need sleep." IM: "Your appearance needs sleep."	N/A
إمبارح	yesterday	أَمْسَ
الشُّغْل	work	الشُّغْل أَوْ الْعَمَل
من الساعة سابعة الصُّبْح لعشرة ليل	LM: " from 7 o'clock in the morning to 10 o'clock at night" من ... لِ	منإلى
بِاشْتِغَالٍ عَلَى	I am working on	اشْتَغَلْتُ فِي أَوْ أَعْمَلُ فِي
مَشْرُوع	project	same
رُحْتُ	I went	ذَهَبْتُ note following the dialogue
علشان	because	لأن
جَعَّان	hungry	جوعان
أَخَذْتُ/خَدْتُ	I took	أَخَذْتُ
رَجَعْتُ	I returned	رَجَعْتُ
الساعة إثناشر	12 o'clock	الساعة الثانية عشرة
ليل	at night	بالليل
علشان كده	because of this	لهذا
تَّعْبَان	tired	same
إنهارده	today	اليوم
عَمَلْتُ	I made/I did	عَمَلْتُ
السوق	the market	same
إشْتَرَيْتُ	I bought	إشْتَرَيْتُ
خُضَار	vegetables	same
إتفرَّجت على	I watched	تَفَرَّجْتُ Also different meanings including "spread out." You can check its various meanings in MSA using the online Arabic to English Dictionary .
التلفزيون	TV	التلفاز same
إتكلمت مع	I talked with	تَكَلَّمْتُ مَعَ
صَاحِبَتِي	my female friend	صَاحِبَتِي
نِمْتُ	I slept	نِمْتُ See note following the dialogue

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامة	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى
الساعة عشرة	ten o'clock	الساعة العاشرة
نُص	half	نُصْف
رَبَّنَا يَجْعَلْ أَيَّامَكَ كُلَّهَا حُلُوةً!	LM: "God makes all your days sweet." IM: "May God make all your days pleasant." This is a compliment.	same
وَأَيَّامَكَ إِنَّتَ كَمَا إِن شَاءَ اللَّهُ!	IM: "And yours as well, God willing." (one response to the previous compliment)	أَيْضاً replaced with كَمَا

3. What did you do yesterday?

Listen to the conversation between two colleagues talking about what they did yesterday.



الجَوَّار رَقْم (3)

يُسْرَا: مَا لَكَ يَا عَبْدَ الرَّحْمَنِ؟ سَكَلَكَ مِخْتَاغ نَوْمٍ!

عبد الرحمن: فَعَلًّا... إِمْبَارَح كَانَ يَوْم طَوِيل.

يُسْرَا: عَمَلْتَ إِيهِ إِمْبَارَح؟

عبد الرحمن: كُنْتُ فِي الشُّغْل مِنْ السَّاعَةِ سَبْعَةَ الصُّبْح لِعَشْرَةِ لَيْلٍ عِلْشَان بَاشْتُغَل عَلَى مَشْرُوع.

يُسْرَا: يَا! عَشْرَةَ لَيْلٍ! وَبَعْدِينَ؟

عبد الرحمن: وَبَعْدِينَ رُحْتُ الْمَطْعَمَ عِلْشَان كُنْتُ جَعَّانٌ وَأَخَذْتُ تَاكْسِي وَرَجَعْتُ الْبَيْتَ حَوَالِي السَّاعَةِ إِتْنَاشِر لَيْلٍ.

يُسْرَا: عِلْشَان كِدْهُ أَنْتَ تَعْبَانُ إِنْهَارْدَه.

عبد الرحمن: وَإِنَّتِ؟ عَمَلْتَ إِيهِ إِمْبَارَح؟

يُسْرَا: رُحْتُ السُّوقَ وَإِشْتَرَيْتُ خُضَارَ وَبَعْدِينَ إِتْفَرَّجْتُ عَلَى التِّلْفِيزِيُونِ وَإِتَكَلَمْتُ مَعَ صَاحِبَتِي فِي التِّلْفُونِ وَنَمْتُ حَوَالِي السَّاعَةِ عَشْرَةَ وَنُص.

عبد الرحمن: تَمَام... كَانَ يَوْمِيكَ جَمِيل... رَبَّنَا يَجْعَلْ أَيَّامَكَ كُلَّهَا حُلُوةً!

يُسْرَا: وَأَيَّامَكَ إِنَّتَ كَمَا إِن شَاءَ اللَّهُ!



Figure 3.2.3: "Sitting Couple" by Kesh

Note

In the previous dialogue, you have seen the weak verbs *نمت*, *رحت*, *كنت*. Let's have a look at their conjugations:

Listen and read conjugations of some weak verbs in CA and MSA:

0:00 / 0:00

الماضي في العامية Past tense in CA (نام)	الماضي في العامية Past tense in CA (راج)	الماضي في العامية Past tense in CA (كان)	الماضي في الفصحى Past tense in MSA	المضارع Present tense in MSA	الضمائر Pronouns CA
نِمْتْ	رُحْتُ	كُنْتُ	كُنْتُ	أَكُونُ	أنا
نِمْتْ	رُحْتُ	كُنْتُ	كُنْتُ	تَكُونُ	إنت
نِمْتْ	رُحْتُ	كُنْتُ	كُنْتُ	تَكُونِينَ	إنتِ
تَامْ	رَاخْ	كَانْ	كَانْ	يَكُونُ	هو
تَامِتْ	رَاخْتُ	كَانَتْ	كَانَتْ	تَكُونُ	هي
نِمْنا	رُحْنَا	كُنَّا	كُنَّا	نَكُونُ	إحنا

4. Practice: Complete the dialogue

This is an incomplete dialogue in the audio files. Practice speaking by completing the missing parts in this dialogue:

0:00 / 0:00

سارة: أهلا يا أحمد، عامل إيه؟
أحمد: _____، _____؟
سارة: الحمد لله. عملت إيه إمبراح؟
أحمد: _____
سارة: صحيح حتعمل إيه بكرة؟
أحمد: _____
سارة: ياه، أنت مَشغول أوي. ممكن تيجي معايا الحفلة بكرة؟
أحمد: _____
سارة: تمام... على فكرة، لما حنروح الحفلة بكرة، ممكن نتعشّي. أنت كل يوم بتتعشّي إمتى؟
أحمد: _____، _____؟
سارة: بتعشّي حوالى الساعة سابعة.
أحمد: _____!
سارة: إن شاء الله، أشوفك بكرة.

[1] Abbas Al-Tonsi and Laila Al-Sawi, An Intensive Course in Egyptian Colloquial Arabic, Part 1 (American University in Cairo 1986) 8

[2] Al-Tonsi, 8

3.3: Cultural insights- Phone conversations and communicating among different age groups in the Arab world



Figure 3.3.1: "Cell Phone Number Pad" by rickyysanne

Between young people in the Arab world, texting and social media like Facebook and applications like WhatsApp are commonly used instead of email to plan an outing or meeting. However, it is culturally inappropriate to only text an older person to set up an appointment. Calling an older person (friend or acquaintance) or a manager (in a work setting) is more appropriate for any kind of communication.

The concept of time is more fluid in the Arab culture where parties can extend for hours; showing up on time is not very common. This is why it is important to have a cell phone to check if the person is on the way to the meeting place or not, especially in big cities where traffic can be an issue.

This page titled [3.3: Cultural insights- Phone conversations and communicating among different age groups in the Arab world](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa \(PDXOpen publishing initiative\)](#) .

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

4: Chapter 4

4.1: Transitioning to CA- Negation in MSA vs CA

4.2: Accepting and rejecting invitations

4.3: Cultural insights- Tips on dealing with culturally sensitive situations

This page titled [4: Chapter 4](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa](#) ([PDXOpen publishing initiative](#)).

4.1: Transitioning to CA- Negation in MSA vs CA

During your studies of MSA, you have probably noticed that the present tense is negated using لا, past tense using ما, and non-verbal sentences using ليس. There are more tools of negation like لا النافية, لا الناهية, لن, لم, لم. The good news is that in CA, the negation is much simpler with fewer tools to use.

One of the equivalents of ليس in the Egyptian dialect is مش. In the Levant, it is ما, and in the Gulf, مو. You can add مش before non-verbs to negate, regardless of the gender.

Examples:

Mahmoud is not tall.

محمود مش طويل.

Samiya is not tall.

سامية مش طويلة.

The boys are not tall.

الأولاد مش طوال.

The two boys are not tall.

الولدين مش طوال.

Note

The dual is used in CA but treated grammatically as plural. The word طوال is the broken plural for طويل. The dual pronouns like أنتما, هما are not used in CA.

أحمد مش عايز قهوة.

I.M is: Ahmed does not want coffee.

L.M is: Ahmed is not the “wanter” of the coffee/is not wanting coffee.

صفية مش عايزة قهوة.

I.M: Safiyaa does not want coffee.

L.M: Safiyaa is not the “wanter” of the coffee/is not wanting coffee.

Note

عايز, عايزة are not verbs in Arabic; they are active participles known as اسم فاعل. Read more [here](#) about the active participle in English. For more explanation and examples on the active participle in ECA, check [this link](#).

To negate verbs, whether present or past, in ECA use ما before the verb and ش after it. For example, “We do not eat” is:

ما بتاكلش

Read and listen to following examples of present tense verbs and their negation:

▶ 0:00 / 0:00 ————— 🔊 ⋮

الضمائر	الفعل في المضارع	الفعل المنفي في المضارع جملة	المعنى باللغة الإنجليزية Negated verb in a sentence
أنا	بَافُهِمْ	مَا بَافُهِمْش قَرُوسَاوِي.	I do not understand French.
إنت	يَنْقُرَا	مَا يَنْقُرَاش جَرَايِد.	You don't read newspapers.
إنت	يَنْكُتِي	مَا يَنْكُتِيَش فِي الْوَرَق لِيهِ؟	Why don't you (f.s.2) write in the papers?
هو	يَبَاكُلْ	مَا يَبَاكُلْش كَثِير.	He doesn't eat a lot.
هي	يَتَلْعَبْ	مَا يَتَلْعَبْش فِي الرَّمْل.	She doesn't play in the sand.
إحنا	يَنْشُرَبْ	مَا يَنْشُرَبْش شَيْيَّة.	We do not smoke shisha. (يَنْشُرَبْ also means "drink")
إنتم	يَنْطَبُخُوا	مَا يَنْطَبُخُواش الصُّبْح.	You (all) don't cook in the morning.

To negate the future, just formulate the future verb in ECA by adding ح before the present tense. The second step is using **مش** before the verb. For example:

مِش حَنَلْعَبْ هِنَا.

We will not play here.

مِش حَاكُلْ فِي الْمَطْعَم دِه

I will not eat in this restaurant!

Note

In the future tense, the present-tense “ب” is deleted.

Mini-Dialogues: Examples of using negations and invitations

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي في الفصحى
والله	LM: "by God" IM: (emphasis)	same
نروح	we go	تذهب
حاجة ساقعة	LM: "something cold" IM: "a cold drink" (incl. soda pop)	شرب ساقع أو شرب بارد
أجري	I run	same
تيجي معايا	LM: " come with me" IM: " join me"	تأتي معي
مش فاضي	not free (for a person) not empty (for an object)	N/A
بس	but	(also used in CA) لكن
الأسبوع الجاي	next (the coming) week	الأسبوع القاي
مشغول	busy	same
ما عنديش وقت	I don't have time.	ليس عندي وقت.
فرصة تانيه	LM: "second chance" IM: "There will be another time to meet or do what was planned."	فرصة قايمة
إمتحان	exam	same
ما باكلش	ما + باكل + ش I do not eat	لا أكل
الهندي	Indian	same
الصيني	Chinese	same
عصير فصب	sugar cane juice [Wikipedia]	same
ما يشربش	I do not drink	لا أشرب
عصير رمان	pomegranate juice	same

▶ 0:00 / 0:00 ———— 🔊 ⋮

سارة: تحب ناكل أيس كريم يا تاسيم؟
باسم: لا والله / مش عايز، بس مُمَكِّن نروح الكوفي شوب ونشرب حاجة ساقعة.

سامية: أنا عايزة أروح النادي علشان أجري في التراك، تيجي معايا؟

مايكل: والله أنا مَشْغُول وما عنديش وقت، مُمكن فُرصة ثانية؟

نورا: يا مُصْطَفَى، عِنْدَكَ وقت نِروح السينما يوم الجمعة؟
مُصْطَفَى: مِش فاضي، عِنْدِي إِمْتِحَان بس ممكن نروح الأسبوع الجاي.

نادية: يلا نروح المطعم الهندي!
عبد الله: أنا ما باكلش الأكل الهندي، بس ممكن نروح المطعم الصيني.

مُصْطَفَى: تحبي تيجي معايا نشرب عصير قصب؟
فرح: آه، حاجي مَعَاكَ، بس ما بشربش عصير قصب، حاشرب عصير زُمان.

This page titled [4.1: Transitioning to CA- Negation in MSA vs CA](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa](#) (PDXOpen publishing initiative) .

4.2: Accepting and rejecting invitations

1. Accepting an invitation to lunch

كلمات وتعبيرات مهمة:

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامة	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى
تَجِبِّي تَتَعَدِّي؟ تَجِب تَتَعَدِّي؟	Would you (f.s.2) like to have lunch? (m.s.2)	هل تَحْبِبِينَ أَنْ تَأْكُلِي الغداء؟ Note: MSA usually requires “أَنْ” between two verbs (except in certain grammatical structures). In CA, you can put two verbs together without “أَنْ”.
معايا	With me (regardless of gender) (ECA) (LCA) مَعِي	مَعِي
بُكْرَة	tomorrow	غَدًا
حَوَالِي	approximately	حَوَالِي
مُمْكِن	possible (question or statement depending on intonation)	مِنَ الْمُمُمْكِنِ (أَنْ)
يَتَأَسَّيْكَ؟	LM: “Does it suit you?” (f.s.2) IM: “Does it work for you?”	هل يُنَاسِبُكَ؟
والله إِنْ كُنَّ دُؤُوق (زوق).	LM: “By God, you are all thoughtful.” (compliment) IM: “By God (for emphasis), you are very thoughtful.”	
إِنْ اللَّي كَلَّكَ ذُوق.	LM: “You are the one who is thoughtful.” (answer to the previous compliment)	اللِّي is the relative pronoun equivalent to all of the MSA relative pronouns which include: الذي، التي، الذين... إلخ

▶ 0:00 / 0:00



الجَوَار رَقْم (1)

هَشَام: أَهْلًا يَا مَرْيَمَ، عاملة إيه؟

مَرْيَم: الحمد لله وإنت؟

هَشَام: الحمد لله، تَحْبِبِي تَتَعَدِّي معايا بُكْرَة ومع سارة وَمَحْمُود؟

مريم: أَكِيد... بُكْرَة إمتى؟

هَشَام: حَوَالِي الساعة ثلاثة؟ يَتَأَسَّيْكَ؟

هدى: أَكِيد... مُمْكِن طَبْعًا، والله إِنْ كُنَّ دُؤُوق (زوق).

هَشَام: إِنْ اللَّي كَلَّكَ ذُوق.

2. Politely rejecting an invitation to an outing

كلمات وتعبيرات مهمة:

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى
خِطْلَع	we will go	سنذهب
تَعَالِي (إنت)	Come!	same
مَعَاد	appointment	ميعاد
ما في مُشْكَلَة	(there is) no problem	ليس هناك مشكلة
مَعَكُمْ	with you (plural) (LCA)	same
مُسْتَحِيل	impossible	same

▶ 0:00 / 0:00

الجَوَّار رقم (2)

مايكل: نانسي، كيفك؟

نانسي: نحمد الله/ كيفك أنت؟

مايكل: منيح، صحيح، إحنا حنطلع على السينما بُكرة، إنت جاية طبعاً؟

نانسي: بُكرة؟ صَعْب، عندي معاد عند الدكتور.

مايكل: تَعَالِي على السينما بعد معاد الدكتور، ما في مُشْكَلَة.

نانسي: أحب أكون مَعَكُمْ بس والله مستحيل، مَرَّة تَأْتِيَة إن شاء الله.

مايكل: أكيد إن شاء الله.

3. Practice: Complete the dialogue

This is an incomplete dialogue in the audio files. Practice speaking by completing the missing parts in this dialogue:

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية	الكلمة والتعبير المساوي بالفصحى
نروح	we go (present tense)	نذهب
مَافِيش مُشْكَلَة	(there is) no problem (ECA)	ليس هناك مشكلة

▶ 0:00 / 0:00

صفية: تِجِبْ نروح السينما؟

ياسين: _____

صفية: ممكن الساعة خمسة؟

ياسين: _____

صفية: ممكن الساعة ستة، مَافِيش مُشْكَلَة!

ياسين: _____

This page titled [4.2: Accepting and rejecting invitations](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa](#) (PDXOpen publishing initiative) .

4.3: Cultural insights- Tips on dealing with culturally sensitive situations



Figure 4.3.1: "Fluffy Kitten Looking Up" by KarolynAnn

Communicating between people of different cultures, speaking in their second or third language is exciting but presents frequent chances for misunderstanding. It is important to keep an open mind, especially if you encounter a sensitive or uncomfortable situation in an Arab country. For example, if you are busy and you are invited to lunch or an outing, but your friend cannot accept your "No," what would you do so as not to offend your friend and still not attend the outing? You can explain the reason and offer to make it up another time. Some of the expressions used in these situations are listed in dialogue 2 and the mini-dialogues in this chapter.

Consider also questions that are culturally accepted in the Arab world in the first encounter but not in the US (for example, age, religion, marital status, etc). If you do not feel comfortable answering them, you can politely refuse by saying that in your culture, it is considered personal. Explaining why you cannot answer could also be a learning opportunity for the other person. Speaking a second language is an ongoing learning process that includes learning the target culture and will always provide perspectives on new ideas and ways of life.

This page titled [4.3: Cultural insights- Tips on dealing with culturally sensitive situations](#) is shared under a [CC BY-NC](#) license and was authored, remixed, and/or curated by [Lina Gomaa \(PDXOpen publishing initiative\)](#) .

Index

D

dire

Glossary

Sample Word 1 | Sample Definition 1

Glossary

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية
حاجة ساقعة	a cold drink
الساعة إثناشر	12 o'clock
شوية	a little bit
حوالي	approximately
إنت عيانة؟	Are you sick?
باليل / بليل	at night
في الكافيتريا	at the cafeteria
جميلة	beautiful
علشان	because
علشان كده	because of this
المدير	boss/ director
مَشْغُول	busy
بس	but
الصيني	Chinese
تعالى (إنت)	Come! (f.s.2)
تعالى (إنت)	Come! (m.s.2)
تيجي معايا	LM: "Come with me"
طيب	delicious/ OK/ kind
مُتَاقِشَات	discussions
طبق	dish/ plate
سواق	driver
يتاشيك؟	Does it work for you? (f.s.2)
الأدب الإنجليزي	English literature
خُسْ (إنت)	enter (m.s.2)
إمْتِحَان	exam
كُتِبْ	wrote (f.s.2)
خِناقَات	fights and arguments
مَلِيَان	filled
من الساعة سابعة الصبح لعشرة بليل	from 7 o'clock in the morning to 10 o'clock at night
ربنا يجعل أيامك كلها حلوة!	God makes your days all sweet
مينيخ	good
صباح الثور	good morning (response)
صَبَاحُ الْخَيْرِ	good morning

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية
نُص	half
أَكَلَ	he ate
إِمْتِحَانَاتِهِ	his exams
الوَاجِبَات	homework
كَيْفْ	how
أَخْبَارُكَ إِيه؟	How are you? (ECA)
إِرَّيَّكَ؟	How are you? male recipient (ECA)
كَيْفَكَ؟	How are you? male recipient (LCA)
كَام	how much/many
جَعَان	hungry
بِاسْتِغْلَ عَلَى	I am working on
مَا عِنْدِي ش وَقْت	I don't have time
بِأَفْطَر	I eat breakfast
بِأَكْلَ الْعِشَا	I eat dinner
بِأُزُوح	I go
عَمَلْتُ	I made/I did
رَجَعْتُ	I returned
أَجْرِي	I run
بِأَنَام	I sleep
نِمْتُ	I slept
بِأَزَاكِرْ	I study
أَخَذَ	I take
إِنكَلَمْتُ مَعَ	I talked with
أَخَذْتُ / خَدْتُ	I took
فِيهِمْتُ	I understood
بِأَصْحَى	I wake up
بِدِّي	I want/would like (ECA)
(عَايز- عَايزَة)	I want/would like (LCA)
إِنْفَرَّجْتُ عَلَى	I watched
رُحْتُ	I went
خَاشْتِيرِي	I will buy
حَادِّيْكَ	I will give you (f.s.2)
خَارُوح	I will go

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية
خَارُوح لِّلْدُكُّتُور	I will go to the doctor
حشوفك	I will see you
آخُد مِنِّكَ	I will take from you
لَو سَمَّخْتِ (إنتِ)	If you please (female recipient)
مِن قَضْلِكَ (إنتِ)	If you please (female recipient)
لَو سَمَّخْتِ (إنتِ)	If you please (male recipient)
مِن قَضْلِكَ (إنتِ)	If you please (male recipient)
على فين؟	IM: "where?"
رايح	IM: "going"
ماعنديش وقت	IM: "I don't have the time."
بسيّين جنيه	IM: "60 Egyptian pounds (cost)"
أحسن من الأول	IM: "better than before."
بالسلامة	IM: "travel safely."
عِنْدَكَ (إنتِ)	IM: "You have"
عِنْدُكَ (إنتِ)	IM: "You have"
مُسْتَحِيل	impossible
خَلِيب	milk
الهندي	Indian
صحيح	correct or by the way (depending on the context)
مُمْكِن	possible
المحاضرات	Lectures (singular محاضرة)
شِمال	left
شِمال في يمين	left then right
فُرْصَة تَائِيَة	LM: "another chance" IM: "There will be another time to meet or do what was planned."
والله	LM: "by God" IM: For emphasis
حاجة ساقعة	LM: "something cold" IM: "a cold drink" (incl. soda pop)
على طول	LM: "all the time"
فُرْصَة تَائِيَة	IM: "There will be another time to meet or do what was planned to be done but did not."

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية
عُنْدِي بَرْد	LM: "at me is cold" IM: "I have cold."
والله	LM: "by God"
والله إنتِ كُلُّكِ دُوق (زوق)	IM: "by God, you are very thoughtful." (compliment)
الشيك	IM: "the receipt or bill"
إنتِ اللي كلِكِ ذوق	LM: "You are the one who is thoughtful"
دَخَلْتُ	entered (m.s.2)
رَبُّنَا مَعَاكِي	May God be with you
سَلَامَتِكِ	May you feel better
دَوَا	medicine
إِجْتِمَاعَات	meetings
عداد	meter
فُلُوس	money
أَوْلَادِي	my children
صَاحِبَتِي	my female friend
حَبِيبَتِي	my loved/dear one
الْأُسْبُوعِ الْجَاي	next week
دَوْشَة	noise
مَش فَاظِي	not free (for a person) not empty (for an object)
طَيِّب	OK/alright
دَرَجَة	One of its meanings is "class" in a train.
وَلَا	or
نَجَح	passed/succeeded
السَّلَامُ عَلَيْكُمْ	Peace be upon you
الصِّدَّائِيَّة	pharmacy
إِنْقَضَّ لِي	please/ go ahead/ here (female recipient)
إِنْقَضَّ لَهِ	please/ go ahead/ here (male recipient)
عَصِيرُ رُمَّان	pomegranate juice
مَشْرُوع	project
بَحْث	research
مَسْئُول عَنْ	responsible for

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية
أَرْجِعْ	return
رايح - جَيّ	return ticket;
رُز	rice
لِعِبْتُ	she played
حَاجَة	something (ECA)
إِشِي	something (LCA)
مِيدَان	square
مَلْفُوف	stuffed leaves (LCA)
عصير قصب	sugar cane juice
أَكِيد	surely
التاكسي	taxi
الساعة عشرة	ten o'clock
النادي	the club
الصبح	(the) morning
ما في مُشْكَلَة	(there is) no problem (LCA)
مَافِيشْ مُشْكَلَة	(there is) no problem (ECA)
المِنِيو	the menu
الرُّوَايَة	the novel
ويعدين	then
ما فيشْ تَعِبْ ولا حَاجَة	There is no trouble
فيه واجب قَاتِي	There is homework which I missed
ديه	this
يوم الخميس	Thursday
تَذَكَّرَة	ticket
تُعْبَان	tired
إِنِّهَارْده	today
بُكْرَة	tomorrow
قَطْر	train
التليفزيون	TV
خُضَار	vegetables
فيتامين سي	vitamin C
بَشْرِيْنَا	we drank
تَحْبِي ... (إنت)؟	would you like?

الكلمة والتعبير بالعامية	المعنى بالإنجليزية
أنت فين من زمان؟	Where are you from a long time?
نروح	we go (present tense)
حَنطَلَع	we will go
حنقرا	we will read
حَنكُتِب	we will write/compose
أهلا و سهلا فيكي	welcome for a female recipient (LCA)
أهلا و سهلا بيك	welcome for a male recipient (ECA)
إيه - شو؟	What?
يَكَام؟	What is the cost of...?
إيه يا نادية؟	What is wrong, Nadia?
مالك؟	what is wrong?
إمّتي؟	when?
فين؟	where? (ECA)
وين؟	where? (LCA)
أّي؟	which?
مين؟	who?
عاش من شافك (إنت)	LM: "Whoever sees you will live!" (compliment)
معايا	With me (regardless of the gender)
مَعَكُمْ	with you (plural)
الشُّغل	work
تَجِبِّي تَتَعَدِي	Would you (f.s.2) to eat lunch?
تَجِب تَتَعَدِي	Would you (m.s.2) to eat lunch?
إمبارح	yesterday
طَبَخْتُو	you (all) cooked
لدرجة إنك تنسى أصحابك	You are forgetting your friends!
سَكَلْكَ مَحْتَاج نوم!	You (m.s.2) look as if you need sleep
يُومَكَ	your day (f.s.2)
سؤالك	your question (male recipient)
سؤالك	your question (female recipient)
ماياكلش	ما + باكل + ش I do not eat
مايشربش	ما + يشرب + ش

I do not drink



Figure 1: "Ornate Doors" by microdot

تمت بفضل الله

Detailed Licensing

Overview

Title: [From MSA to CA: A Beginner's Guide to Transitioning to Colloquial Arabic \(Gomaa\)](#)

Webpages: 32

Applicable Restrictions: Noncommercial

All licenses found:

- [CC BY-NC 4.0](#): 90.6% (29 pages)
- [Undeclared](#): 9.4% (3 pages)

By Page

- [From MSA to CA: A Beginner's Guide to Transitioning to Colloquial Arabic \(Gomaa\)](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [Front Matter](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [TitlePage](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [InfoPage](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [Table of Contents](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [About the Book](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [Licensing](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [About the Author](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [Acknowledgments](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [Abbreviations and Acronyms](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [Introduction](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [1: Chapter 1](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [1.1: Transitioning to CA- Final vowelizing and greeting terms in MSA and CA](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [1.2: Greetings and Ending Conversations](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [1.3: Cultural insight- Ending a conversation in a culturally acceptable manner](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [2: Chapter 2](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [2.1: Transitioning to CA- WH Question words in MSA and CA](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [2.2: Requests](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [2.3: Cultural insights- Giving directions](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [3: Chapter 3](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [3.1: Transitioning to CA- Verb tenses](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [3.2: Dialogues](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [3.3: Cultural insights- Phone conversations and communicating among different age groups in the Arab world](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [4: Chapter 4](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [4.1: Transitioning to CA- Negation in MSA vs CA](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [4.2: Accepting and rejecting invitations](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [4.3: Cultural insights- Tips on dealing with culturally sensitive situations](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [Back Matter](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [Index](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [Glossary](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [Glossary](#) - [CC BY-NC 4.0](#)
 - [Detailed Licensing](#) - [Undeclared](#)